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## SUCCESS OF PKL 3

| | |
|---|---|
| 36% Rise in first week viewership | 213m Total viewership in the first 4 weeks of the season |
| 55% Increase in the urban viewership | 33% Increase in the viewership through Hotstar app |
| 36% Women and children watch this sport, highest for any sport in India | 254% Increase in the activities through Twitter |
| 50% The estimated rural urban split in the viewership | 30% Increase in the number of 4-14 year olds watching the game |

## INITIATIVES BY STAR

#ThighFive

BIG B'S SONG

BTL

YouTube

APPS

Kabaddi Heroes
Kabaddi Mantra
Kabaddi & Beyond Kings of Kabaddi

#KabaddiTrumps

Brand Star

Glamour

SEASON 2

Kabaddi Selfie

5 languages across 8 channels

SEASON 1

2.3 billion impressions on social media

360 degree marketing

FACEBOOK BUS

## OBJECTIVES

Transform Kabaddi into a major sport in India

- Creating world class infrastructure
- Establishing a sustainable pipeline for young talent
- Achieving mass viewership

Key Takeaway: The growth of PKL has opened new avenues for Kabaddi and unravelled immense potential for further development of the sport.

# PRIMARY RESEARCH

8 Focus Group Discussions of 5 participants each

Occasions, needs and repeat viewership were identified as the key drivers of consumption

## Dual Needs of a Kabaddi viewer




Seeing a local hero get recognition and success evokes a sense of aspiration

## Independence of Factors

| Correlation Coefficients | International Players | Advertisement | Local Hero | Recognition | Entertainment | Salary Cap for Teams | In-stadia Engagement | Timing of the league |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| International Players | 1 | | | | | | | |
| Advertisements | 0.082 | 1 | | | | | | |
| Local Hero | 0.312 | 0.378 | 1 | | | | | |
| Recognition | 0.327 | 0.226 | 0.643 | 1 | | | | |
| Entertainment | 0.378 | 0.476 | 0.112 | 0.284 | 1 | | | |
| Salary Cap for Teams | 0.307 | 0.018 | 0.423 | 0.247 | 0.284 | 1 | | |
| In-stadia Engagement | 0.154 | 0.748 | 0.104 | 0.347 | 0.378 | 0.483 | 1 | |
| Timing of the league | 0.746 | 0.259 | 0.351 | 0.027 | 0.082 | 0.305 | 0.744 | 1 |

## Factor Analysis

- Aspirations – Local Hero, Recognition, Salary Cap for Teams
- Continuous Engagement - Timing of the league, Advertisements
- Glamour – In-stadia Engagement, Celebrity Engagement (Entertainment)

Key Takeaway: Aspirations, continuous engagement and glamour are the key focus areas that would drive viewership

# PROMOTIONAL ACTIVITIES ADOPTED

| | ISL | PKL |
|---|---|---|
| ATL | ▪ Advertisements → Fan pages and websites of international leagues<br>▪ Aspirational → Podcasts with Bollywood celebrities<br>▪ Engagement → Yield Reward points, discount on merchandise<br>▪ Emotional Connect → Documentaries covering life history of players |  <br>▪ Advertisements → Emphasis on physique of players – interest in women and evoking aspiration in children<br>▪ Engagements → Newspaper feed links, 1 min rapid fire round on YouTube channel |
| BTL | ▪ Tie-ups with college fests → College students → Communication TG<br>▪ Interschool Tournaments<br>▪ Engagement with travel partners for free rides to stadium<br>▪ Organized Public Screening of sport across various regions, direct call to action | ▪ Interschool Kabaddi tournaments<br>▪ "Train the trainer" program → training Kabaddi coaches, all-in one player development program<br>▪ Training camps and kabaddi games outside malls→ women and underprivileged youth<br>▪ Engaged commuters in local trains as part of victory celebration |





Key Takeaway: PKL and its franchises have adopted a multitude of promotional activities

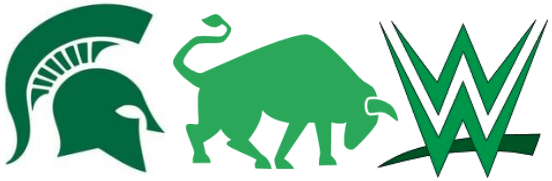
# CONSUMER INSIGHTS

## "Unstated, hidden desires"

Historical sports
- Roman Gladiators

Modern day parallels
- Blood sport-Bull fighting, WWE
- Buying and selling of players

Atavistic and visceral thrill
- Game of Thrones
- Violence in movies
- Football red cards



## "Life is a series of small indulgences"

Everyday escapism
- Break from reality

Projection
- Live your fantasies

'IPL was Blue Ocean into cinema'

Spectator sport is rejuvenating

Vicarious learning
- Awareness through viewership




## "Urban is aspirational for rural"

Emulation
- Urban youth emulate the West
- Rural youth emulate urban youth

Aspiration
- Buzz in urban results in aspiration in rural
- Mall purchase behaviour



Key Takeaway: Magnify the perceived gladiatorial violence; Focus should be urban centres; Shorter, dramatised formats of the game are key success drivers

# PERCEPTIONS

## Current Perception of Kabaddi




## Desired Perception of Kabaddi




## Target Audience of PKL

- Communication Target Audience:
  Urban women and children, belonging to the middle and upper middle classes
- Consumption Target Audience:
  Much wider - geographically and demographically.
  The PKL would be consumed in urban as well as semi-urban areas, and to a large extent, by men as well

## Positioning of PKL

- Kabaddi is currently considered a rural sport, out of touch with the 21st century.
- In order to reverse this perception, the PKL will be positioned as:
  "A modern, glamorous league that showcases an ancient Indian gladiatorial sport highlighting qualities such as courage, fearlessness and ambition, all of which are relevant in today's times"

**Key Takeaway : Popularity and repeat viewership of the sport will increase with an official fantasy league and an official mobile game**

# VISION

| | PRO KABADDI LEAGUE | KABADDI AS A SPORT |
|---|---|---|
| Year 1 | FRANCHISES<br>▪ Still supported majorly by Star network<br>▪ Focus mainly on themselves and Kabaddi | AWARENESS<br>▪ Kabaddi awareness has increased due to PKL<br>▪ Initiation of a regional spirit for the sport |
| Year 4 | SPONSORSHIP AND VOCABULARY<br>▪ Franchises attract more sponsors<br>▪ Kabaddi vocabulary propagated by PKL | GOVERNMENT AIDS<br>▪ The government funding for the sport increases<br>▪ Infrastructure and player development |
| Year 7 | PERCEPTION<br>▪ Captured the imagination of the nation<br>▪ Largely perceived as an urban sport | ESTABLISHED DOMESTIC CULTURE<br>▪ Institute camps at domestic level<br>▪ Conduct bigger tournaments, heavier prize money |
| Year 10 | SELF SUSTAINING<br>▪ Established infrastructure, high ad revenues<br>▪ Mass appeal and sponsorship, more self sustaining | ONE OF THE LEADERS IN MULTI SPORT CULTURE<br>▪ Recognition by corporates, awarding jobs<br>▪ Better returns for the players |

Key Takeaway: A clear eyed, 10 year vision for Kabaddi would ensure success in meeting the key objectives

## INSIGHTS and RATIONALE

- Growing mobile and internet penetration in India
- 'Life is a series of small indulgences'
- What is buzzing in urban becomes aspirational in rural
- Aspirations and Glamour drive viewership
- The presence of local heroes increases aspirations
- Association with stars of established sports generates buzz
- Kabaddi was essentially a rural sport with no pipeline of emerging talent and lack of infra
- The sports scene in India is dominated by Cricket
- For PKL to garner eyeballs, Kabaddi must become a sport of the masses

## CONCEPTS

- DUST TO DREAMS
- PKL DIGITAL
- GRASSROOTS

## VALIDATION

- 85% of the respondents identified association with celebrities as a motivator to watch PKL ✓
- 95% respondents believe that the infrastructure landscape is essential for the development of any sport
- 75% of the respondents considered a fantasy league as a big pull in generating interest in PKL
- 80% of the respondents stated that recall for PKL dropped during off season ✓
- 85% of the respondents stated that a mobile game would increase awareness about PKL

**Key Takeaway : DustToDreams programme shall be taken forward**

# UMBRELLA CAMPAIGN #DustToDreams

**OBJECTIVE**
- Introduce and create awareness about PKL players to the Target Audience
- Generate enthusiasm and create pull for PKL during off-season

## MULTI-SPORT PLAYER CAMPAIGN

**BRIEF**

Viewers showed high curiosity towards players who featured with their favourite stars from other sports

**IMPLEMENTATION**

Promotional campaign featuring star players from multiple leagues talking about Kabaddi as a sport

**TELECAST**

Regional and national sports channels

**EXAMPLE**

KOHLI & CHILLAR

NEHWAL & AJAY KUMAR

## LEVERAGING BRAND STAR FOR TV SOAPS

**BRIEF**
- Major TG (women) regularly follow TV soaps
- Overcome customer inertia

**IMPLEMENTATION**

Players featuring in the high TRP Star Network serials can talk about themselves and the rules of the game.

**TELECAST**

Regional and national serials with high TRPs

**EXAMPLE**

RAKESH KUMAR on Saath Nibhana Saathiya

## CO-BRANDING

**BENEFITS**
- Larger target base
- Lower capital costs

**PROMOTION**
- Tie-up with E-commerce firms/payment wallets
- Movie Collaboration

**IMPLEMENTATION**

Key Takeaway: It is important that the spectators of the sport do not lose touch with the sport during the 40 weeks when the game is not telecasted

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**Key Takeaway : PKL Digital shall be implemented**

# PKL DIGITAL

## OBJECTIVE

- To leverage the internet and mobile penetration in India
- To tap into the “small pleasures” insight

## Official Mobile Game

- Develop on iOS and Android platforms
- Replicate the PKL league format
- Rules followed similar to PKL
- Emphasis on graphics : players and stadiums

### Format of the Game

- Allow the consumer to choose between a PKL season mode of 60 matches, a single match or against a friend over the internet
- In season mode, consumers can buy or sell players after the league gets over to change the strategy and dimension of the team
- Difficulty of the game can be set by the gamer
- Players raid, touch the mark and come back in the stipulated time without touching the boundary with points for successful raids
- The game is played by swiping the player to touch the mark









## Kabbadi Fantasy League

Fantasy leagues create a sense of interest in the sport throughout the season and increased viewership among these players.

### Implementation

- Divide the league into 2 phases of 30 matches each
- Each phase will have 30 substitutes that can be used in that phase
- Matches will be as per the announced schedule of PKL
- Combined team value can't cross a sum total of 100 in value
- Cap on the number of players from a team: maximum of 3 players
- Unlimited substitutes allowed between the two phases
- Captains to score double points for each game
- Points to be awarded for successful defence and raiding
- Creation of leagues allowed between friends/peers etc


Value : 10.0


Value : 9.5


Value : 9.5


Value : 11.0

Key Takeaway : A connect with urban youth coupled with an excitement factor will increase with an official fantasy league and a mobile game

## INSIGHTS and RATIONALE

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**Key Takeaway : Grassroots programme shall be explored further**

# GRASSROOTS PROGRAMME

**TALENT DEVELOPMENT**

- UMumba- Future Stars program
- Bengaluru Bulls- selecting U-16 players
- Initiatives like Parivartan

YOUNG AMBASSDOR MODEL:

Proposal:

- Each franchise chooses an Ambassdor (who plays Kabaddi) from a selected list of schools in order to promote the sport
- The Ambassdor is responsible for branding the sport in the region, coordinating with coaches

COACH-A-THON:

Proposal:

- Prep camp for top 20 players from schools in a region (one week camp)
- 1 player from each region will be selected and will be the face of the regional franchise for that season



**INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT**

- Telugu Titans has invested 100cr in players and infra development
- Bengaluru Bulls plans to set an academy

Stadiums in Government schools: Selected government schools can be aided by a Private-Government partnership to build stadiums

- Simulation systems for players: Based on virtual reality, a simulation system to enhance the technical skills of a player
- Better Medical facilities: Leading medical institutions should provide subsidized checkups on a regular basis to avoid long term injuries
- Touch-and-go System: Innovative method to monitor whether the raider made a touch or not incase of controversial raids and bonus point checks



Key Takeaway: The twin pillars of infrastructure and a pipeline for emerging talent will place Kabaddi firmly on course to becoming a major sport of India

# IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE

In order to achieve our vision for Kabaddi and the PKL, the various ideas previously suggested would be implemented in the following manner:

